

website itself. If you upgrade using Slackware mirrors, and read the changelogs provided on the Slackware website, then you will have no problem. If an upgrade to Package X requires you to upgrade Package Y, then upgraded versions of both X and Y will be released to the mirrors. For example, upgrading Firefox to version 3.5.6 requires an upgrade version of Cairo, version 1.8.8; hence both Cairo and Firefox upgrades have been put up on the mirrors.

If, however, you want to compile and upgrade your own packages, then you need to figure out the dependencies yourself—like running `./configure` on the source package to see if all dependencies are supplied, or you need to upgrade/ install some libraries and packages. Not my cup of tea, I must say!

I would definitely say that Slackware is not for everyone! If you are new to the Linux environment, then you are bound to get lost at certain points. This can be a good learning exercise if you are up for it, but certainly not advisable for everyone. Slackware's problem is the lack of a contemporary approach to design and thinking. "Sulking in the limelight" still reflects its age-old pattern of development and distribution. There have sometimes been adamant attitudes on the part of the developers, like the dropping of official GNOME support in 2005. GNOME is probably the most famous desktop environment; it's the default for the two most famous Linux distributions, Ubuntu and Fedora. Although there are ways of installing GNOME in Slackware, it's not officially supported and as updated as in other distributions.

At other times, there have been efforts to jazz up marketing by jumping versions from 4 to 7 directly, to indicate to users that Slackware is as up-to-date as any other distribution.

Individual verdicts stem from each user's own preference and competence, making the thrust of Slackware, 'To each, his own'. It depends on what users expect from a Linux operating system, and how much they know about it; whether they value security and stability above all, or bleeding-edge software and in-vogue appearances. After all, using Linux requires a little knowledge and getting 'under the hood', no matter how much the developers try to simplify design and maintenance of the system. So, if you have the time and patience to try something new and exciting, Slackware is for you; otherwise, there are other distributions to take care of your needs.  END

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